

TLS 1.3 at a glance & Perfect Forward Secrecy

TLS 1.3: Approved in 2018

Protocol Action: 'The Transport Layer Security (TLS) Protocol Version 1.3' to Proposed Standard (draft-ietf-tls-tls13-28.txt)

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- To: "IETF-Announce" <ietf-announce@ietf.org>
- Subject: Protocol Action: 'The Transport Layer Security (TLS) Protocol Version 1.3' to Proposed Standard (draft-ietf-tls-tls13-28.txt)
- From: The IESG <iesg-secretary@ietf.org>
- Date: Wed, 21 Mar 2018 03:02:02 -0700
- Archived-at: <https://mailarchive.ietf.org/arch/msg/ietf-announce/IhM9JJHVs_ZeK-_1eaVZrqbL8>
- Auto-submitted: auto-generated
- Cc: The IESG <iesg@ietf.org>, draft-ietf-tls-tls13@ietf.org, Sean Turner <sean@sn3rd.com>, Kathleen.Moriarty@ietf.org at [gmail.com](mailto:Kathleen.Moriarty@ietf.org), tls-chairs@ietf.org, rfc-editor@rfc-editor.org, sean@sn3rd.com, tls@ietf.org
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The IESG has approved the following document:

- 'The Transport Layer Security (TLS) Protocol Version 1.3' (draft-ietf-tls-tls13-28.txt) as Proposed Standard

This document is the product of the Transport Layer Security Working Group.

The IESG contact persons are Kathleen Moriarty and Eric Rescorla.

TLS 1.3: Approved in 2018

[\[Docs\]](#) [\[txt|pdf\]](#) [\[draft-ietf-tls-...\]](#) [\[Tracker\]](#) [\[Diff1\]](#) [\[Diff2\]](#) [\[IPR\]](#) [\[Errata\]](#)

PROPOSED STANDARD

Errata Exist

Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF)

E. Rescorla

Request for Comments: 8446

Mozilla

Obsoletes: [5077](#), [5246](#), [6961](#)

August 2018

Updates: [5705](#), [6066](#)

Category: Standards Track

ISSN: 2070-1721

The Transport Layer Security (TLS) Protocol Version 1.3

Abstract

This document specifies version 1.3 of the Transport Layer Security (TLS) protocol. TLS allows client/server applications to communicate over the Internet in a way that is designed to prevent eavesdropping, tampering, and message forgery.

This document updates RFCs 5705 and 6066, and obsoletes RFCs 5077, 5246, and 6961. This document also specifies new requirements for TLS 1.2 implementations.

Status of This Memo

This is an Internet Standards Track document.

This document is a product of the Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF). It represents the consensus of the IETF community. It has received public review and has been approved for publication by the Internet Engineering Steering Group (IESG). Further information on Internet Standards is available in [Section 2 of RFC 7841](#).

TLS 1.3: weak ciphers' pruning

→ **Pruned all symmetric algorithms considered legacy.**

⇒ SHA-1, MD5

⇒ RC4, DES, 3DES

⇒ AES-CBC

⇒ (plus a few more technical removals)

→ **What is left?**

⇒ ALL (!) remaining ciphers are AEAD (Authenticated Encryption with Associated Data)

→ AEAD: no more CCA (Padding Oracle, Lucky 13. etc).

⇒ Notation: TLS_AEAD_HASH (hash used for HKDF):

→ TLS_AES_128_GCM_SHA256

→ TLS_AES_256_GCM_SHA384

→ TLS_CHACHA20_POLY1305_SHA256

→ TLS_AES_128_CCM_SHA256

→ TLS_AES_128_CCM_8_SHA256

TLS 1.3 handshake

→ TLS1.2: four pubkey handshake methods supported

- ⇒ RSA key transport (most common)
- ⇒ Anonymous Diffie-Hellman
- ⇒ Fixed Diffie-Hellman
- ⇒ Diffie-Hellman Ephemeral

→ TLS1.3: removed all, except one!

- ⇒ Diffie-Hellman Ephemeral

→ Why? **Forward Secrecy!**

- ⇒ What's this? See next slides 😊
- ⇒ But also get rid of RSA issues (Bleichenbacher Oracle, ...)

What is perfect forward secrecy?

→ At the very minimum:

⇒ If a session key is compromised this should NOT compromise data exchanged neither BEFORE nor AFTER.

→ Actually more than this!

⇒ if a long-term **private key** (e.g. of the server!!) is compromised at some time, this should also NOT affect data delivered BEFORE such time!

→ **In essence: PFS guarantees that session keys will not be compromised even if long-term secrets used in the session key exchange are compromised**

Why PFS is today more and more important?

→ Protects against a more powerful attacker model

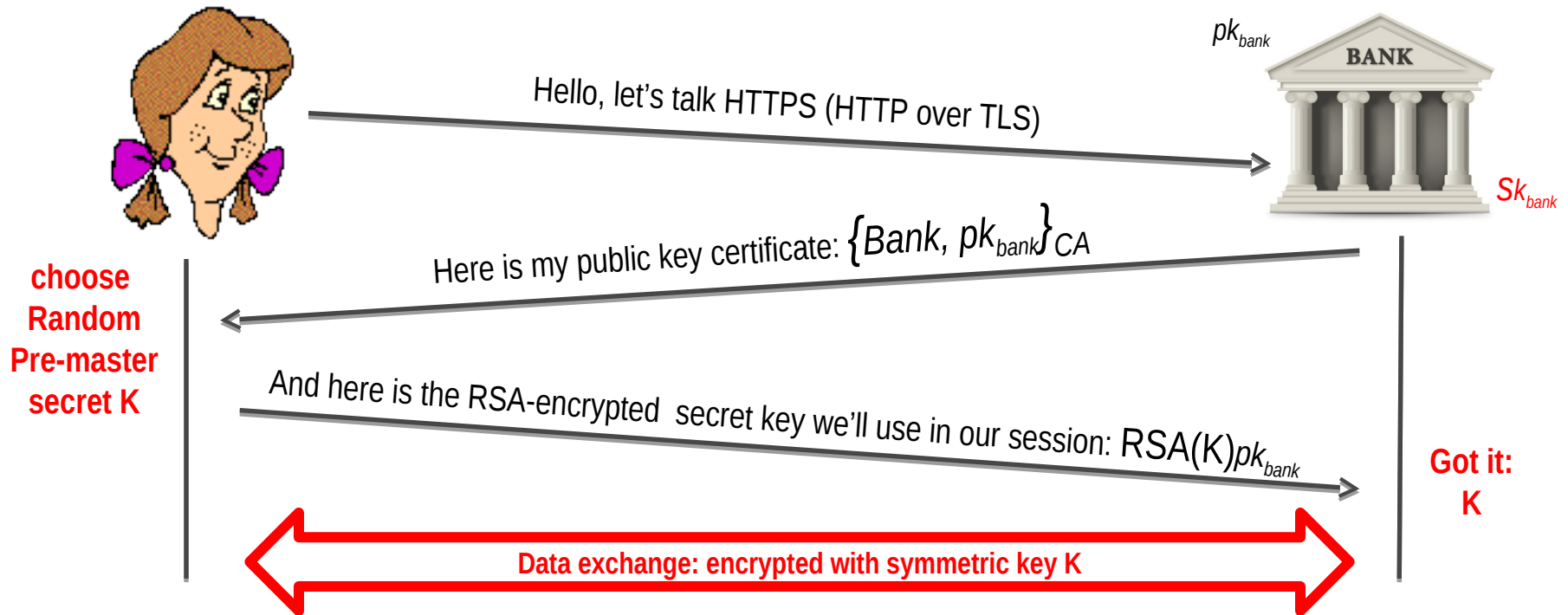
⇒ Capable of **logging huge amount of data**

→ E.g. a mass-surveillance program capturing all network traffic (remember Snowden...)

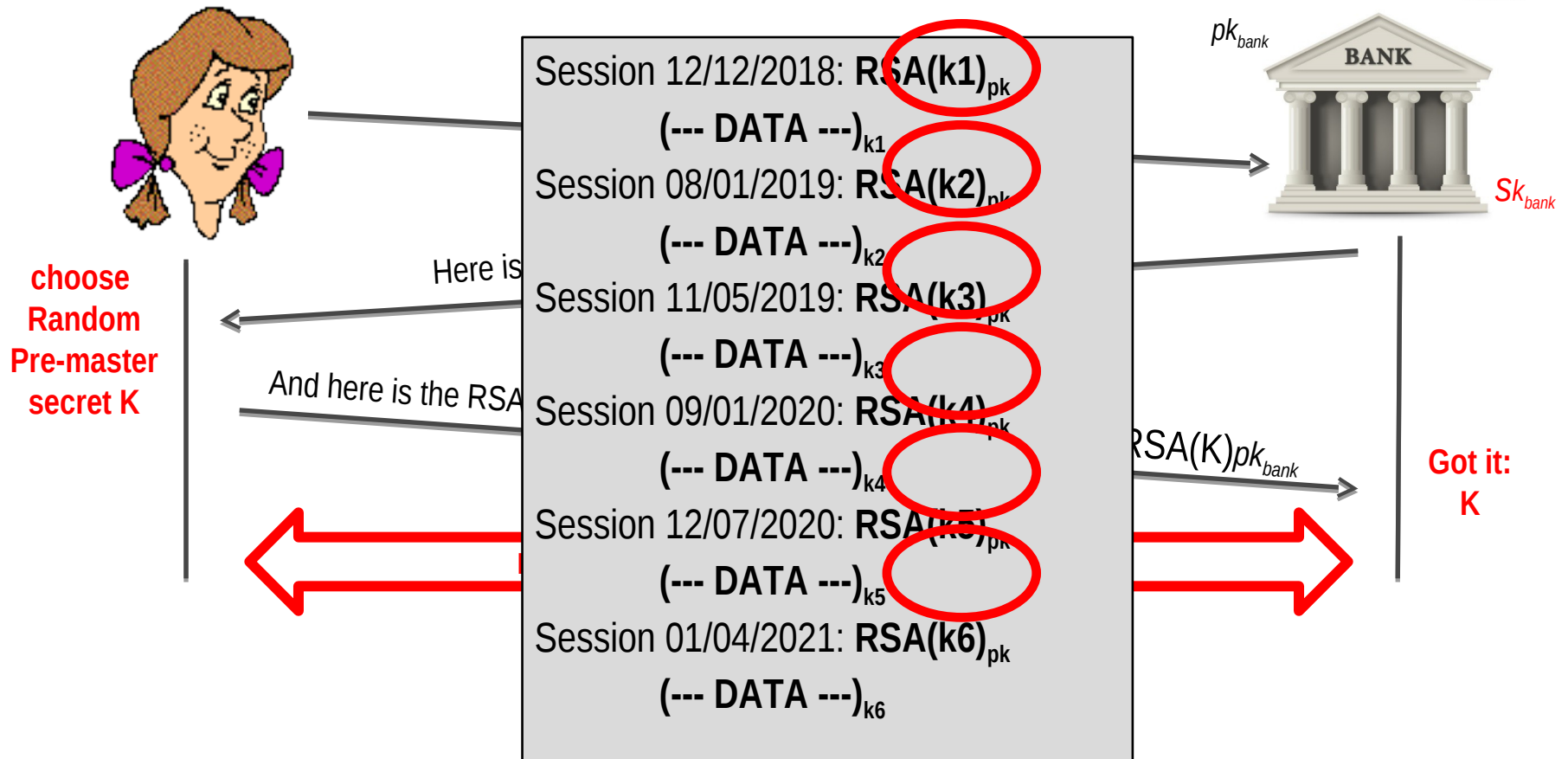
⇒ Capable to **occasionally break a public/private key pair**

→ E.g. via a SW bug in the implementation – (remember heartbleed)

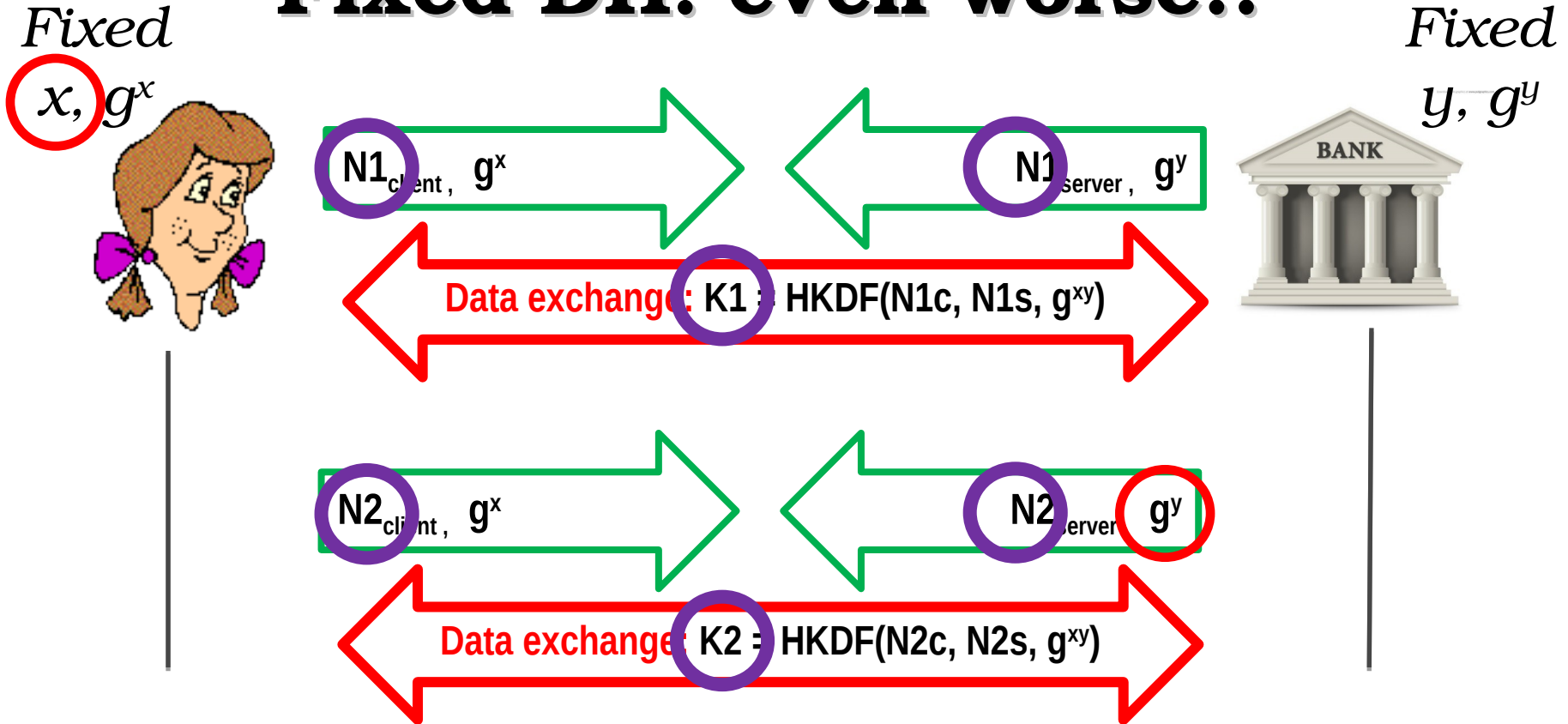
Traditional RSA key transport: no PFS!!



Traditional RSA key transport: no PFS!!



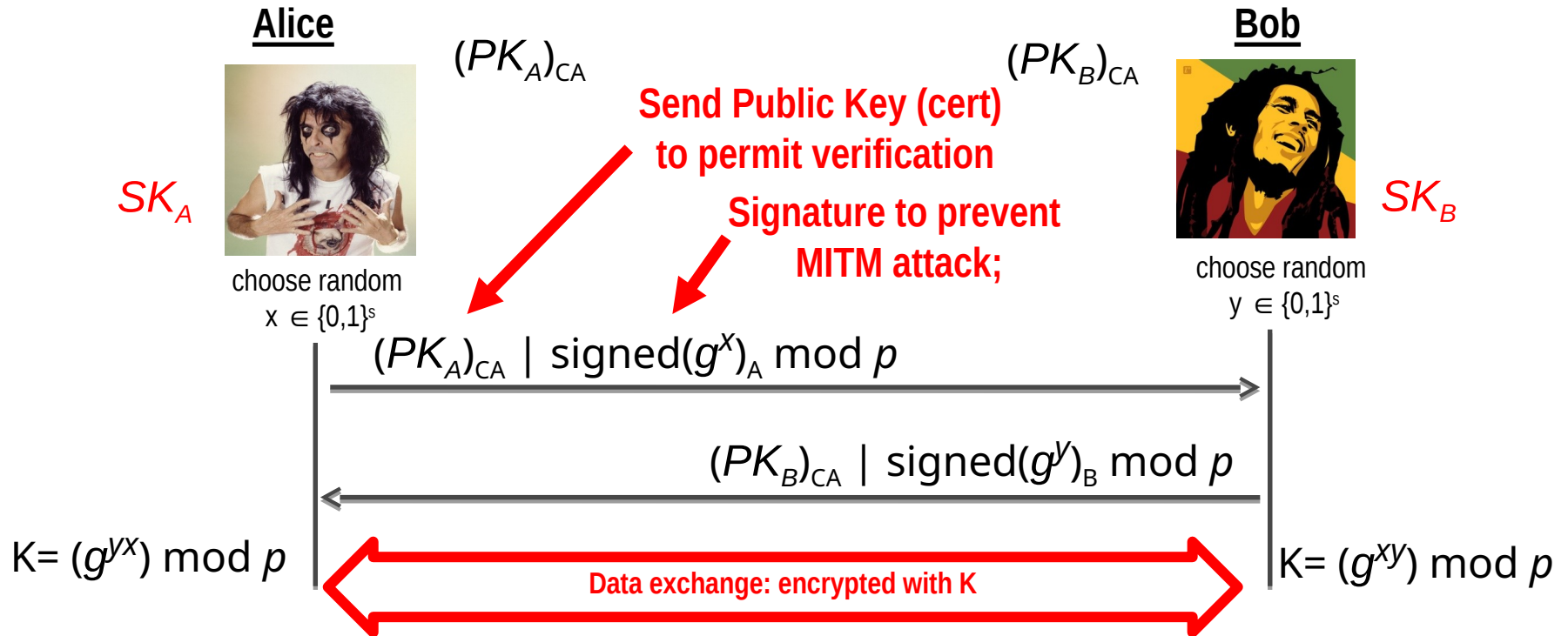
Fixed DH: even worse!!



Breach 25/11/2021 $\rightarrow$ x (or y) exposed $\rightarrow g^{xy}$ disclosed!

$\rightarrow$ compute $K2$ (nonces in hello msg) $\rightarrow$ And all past K !!

Ephemeral Diffie-Hellman: PFS!



If SK breaks, (ephemeral) session keys are not revealed! Forward Secrecy!

And even AFTER breach, if attacker is only passive (but MITM now possible)

What about PFS vs pre-shared key?

WPA2 key
 $K = 31EF21456$

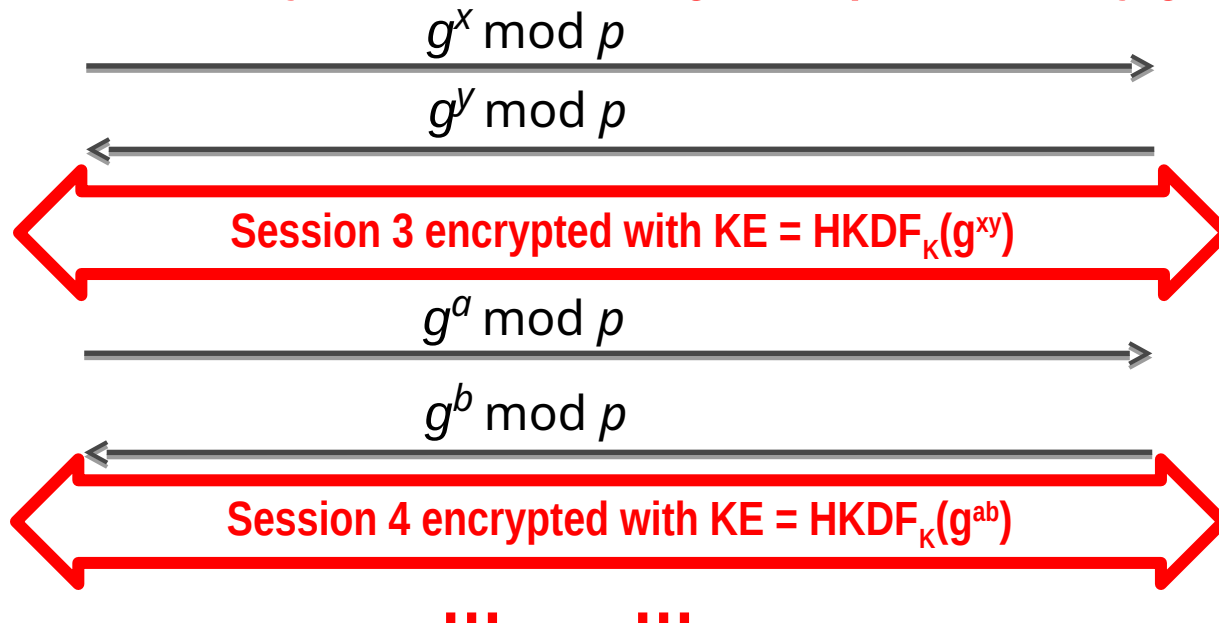


WPA2 key
 $K = 31EF21456$

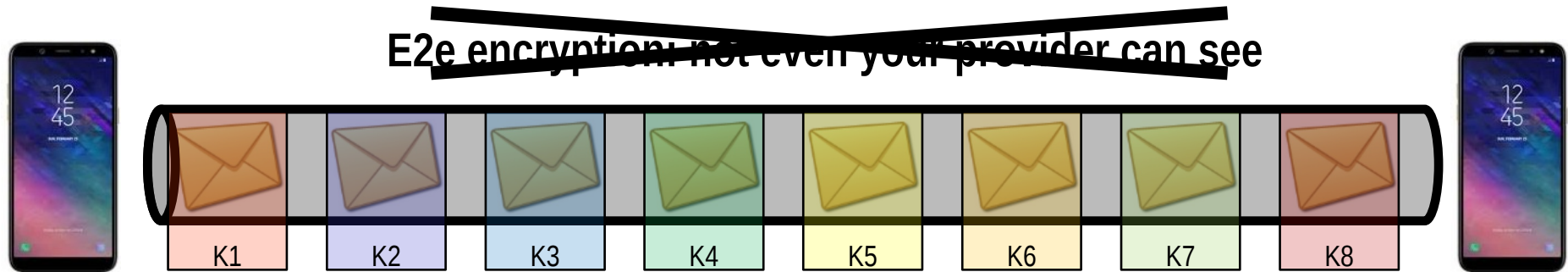


We must use same static K ... how to get PFS then???

Add an anonymous DH exchange for ephemeral key gen!



Forward Secrecy & messaging apps



E2e encryption **with PFS**: Not only your provider cannot see,
But **even if it logs all data and gets access later on to your
key, he cannot decrypt past messages!**

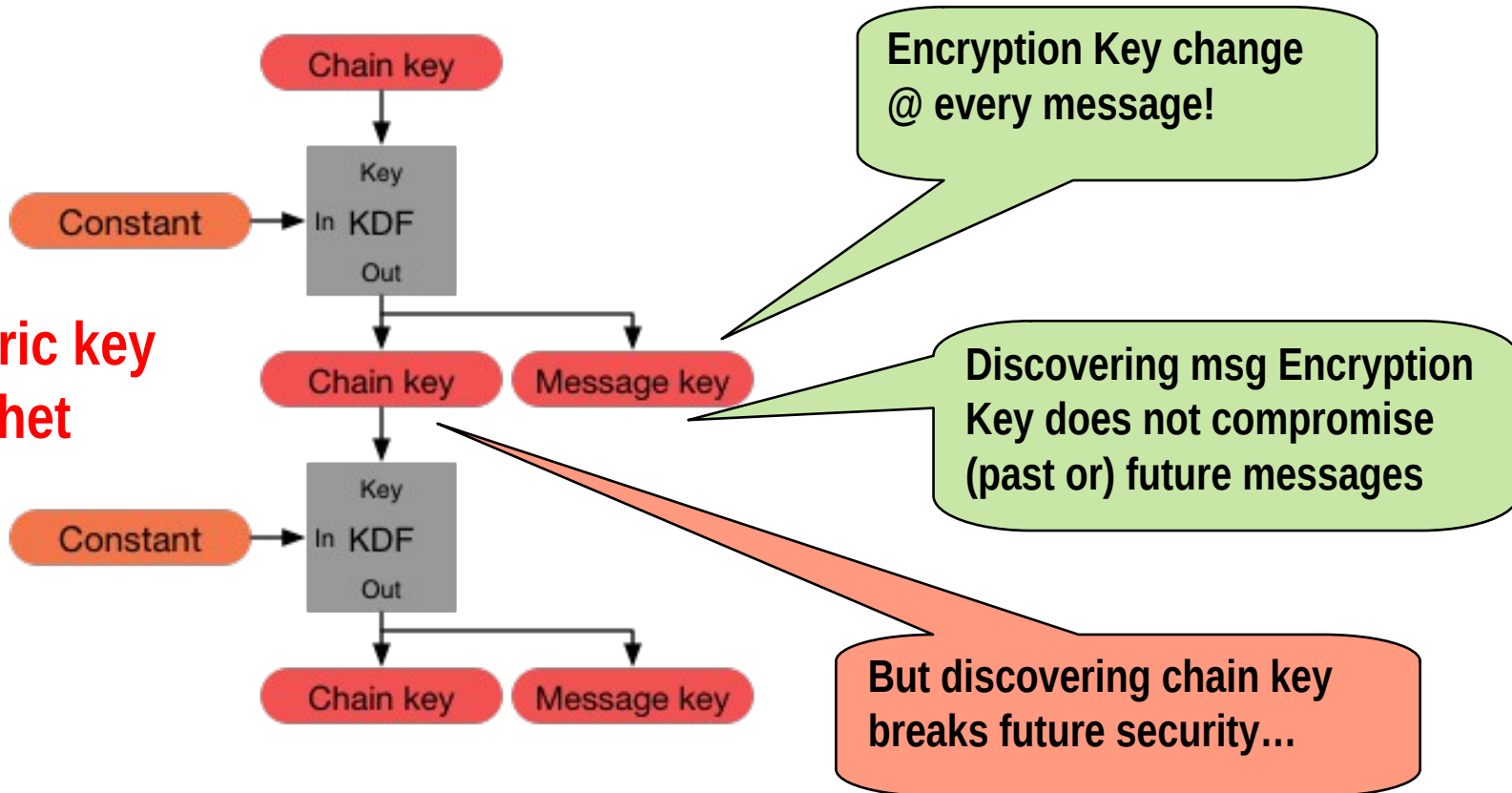


Signal's Double Ratchet: brilliant solution!

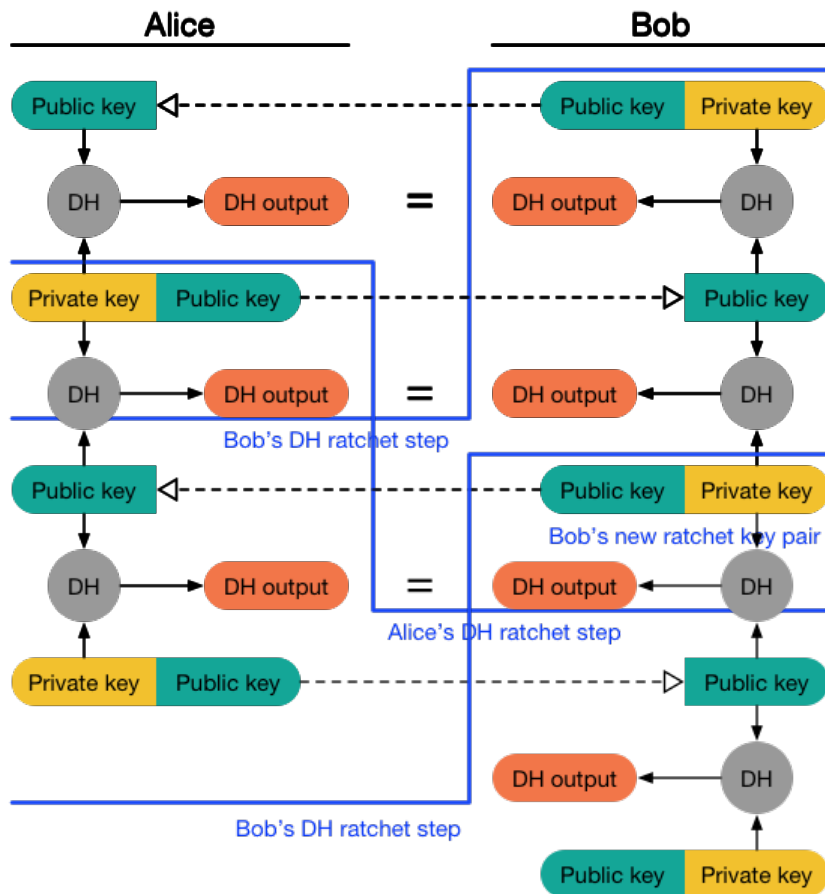


Double ratchet: combines a KDF chain...

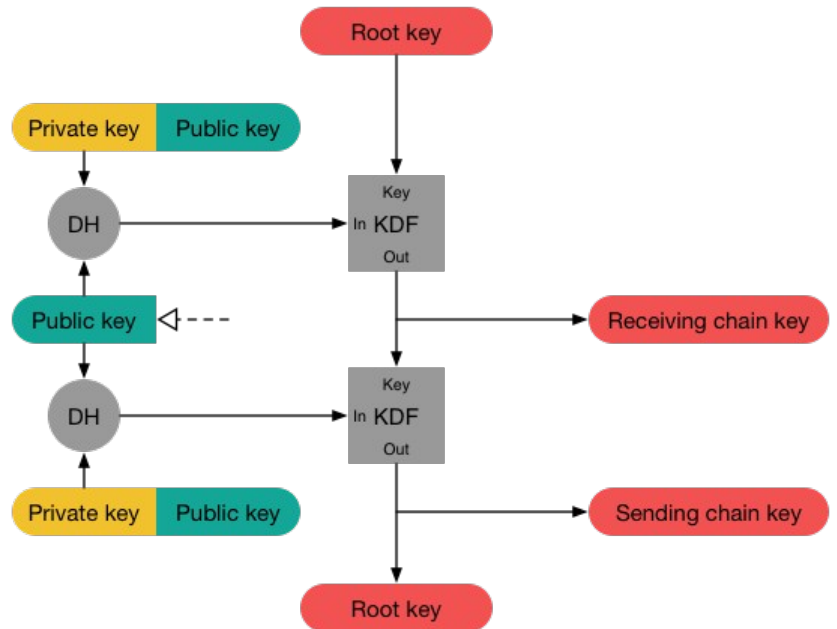
Symmetric key Ratchet



.... With a DH ratchet, to guarantee forward secrecy!



Diffie-Hellman Ratchet

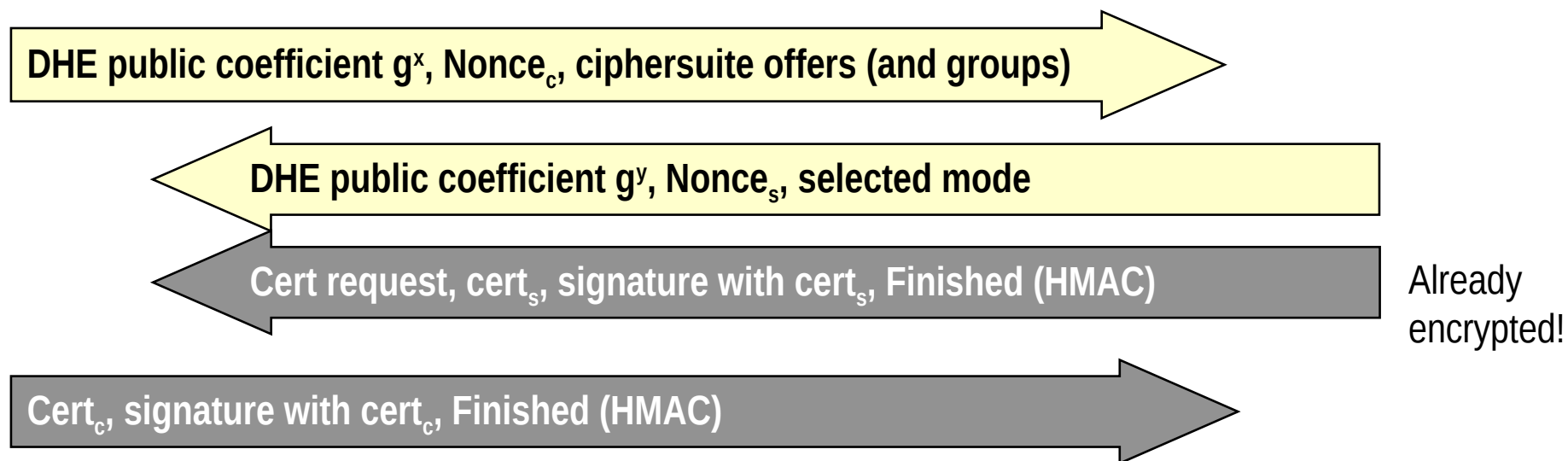


Double ratchet = Sym key ratchet + DH ratchet

TLS 1.3 handshake: Faster and more secure!

→ **With only DHE left (no more RSA transport):**

- ⇒ 3-way handshake versus 4-way! → faster setup
- ⇒ Perfect forward secrecy



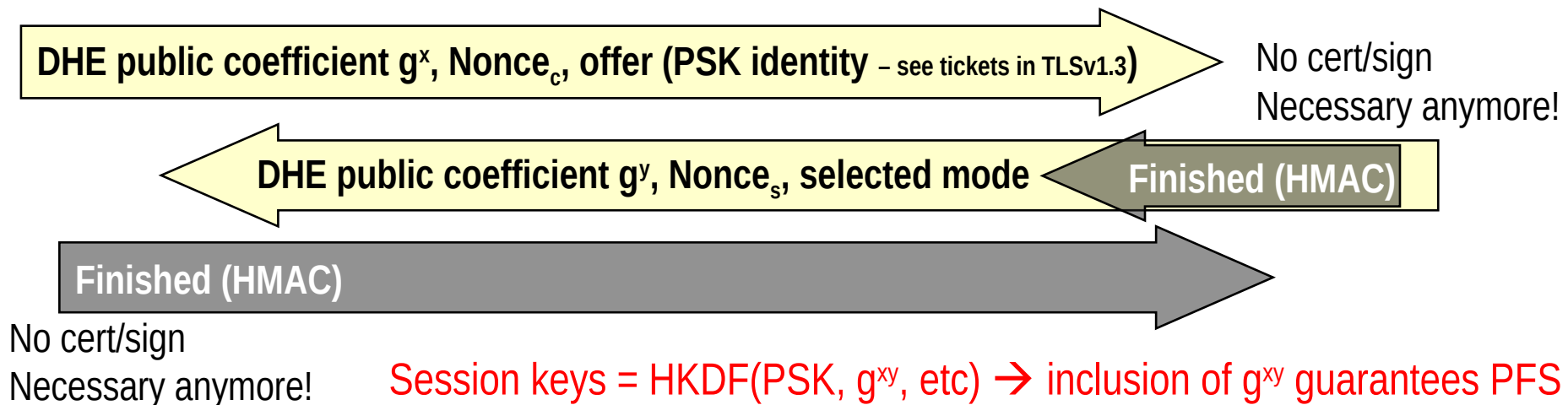
*Side effect of early encryption: IDENTITY PROTECTION!
(certificates never transmitted in clear)
(not very useful in web, but keep in mind for different TLS scenarios...)*

TLS 1.3 handshake:

Further options

→ Pre-Shared Key

- ⇒ PSK, already added in TLS 1.2; PSK is either
 - Agreed offline in constrained environments
 - Computed during the first handshake and then reused in subsequent TLS connections
- ⇒ New in TLS1.3: optional support for forward secrecy
 - Combines pre-shared key with a fresh DHE



New handshake structure – wrap-up

CLIENT

SERVER

Client Hello

DH, PSK, extra data, application data if PSK, etc

Server Hello

DH key share

Encrypted Certificate + ceryificate verify + finished

Encrypted Certificate + ceryificate verify + finished

Application Data

VERY MUCH DIFFERENT!

3-way handshake

No more change Cipher specs

Handshake encrypted ASAP

Certificate + cert verify both sides

TLS 1.3 handshake:

Further options

→0-RTT Data

- ⇒ When PSK agreed (in previous handshake), send application data directly in first message
 - Use, as key: $\text{HKDF}_{\text{PSK}}(\text{Client-Hello-content})$
 - i.e. «mix» PSK with new nonce, offer, and client's DHE public coefficient
- ⇒ MUCH faster!
 - Compelling use case: send HTTP request directly in very first message: saves a full RTT!
 - Also, very useful in applications relying on short data transfer
- ⇒ **WAY Less security (obvious replay attack): to be used with care... at your own risk!**

Mitigate replay in 0-RTT

→ **Problem: key used in first msg does not include server nonce**

→ **Time window mitigation**

⇒ Include maximum lifetime after first session

→ Standard default = 7 days

⇒ Does not solve... but at least reduces vulnerability period

→ **Control nonce reuse**

⇒ Keep a record of all client nonces

⇒ Hard to deploy in large scale systems

→ Load balancing, multiple servers, etc...

Other TLS 1.3 nits

take home: less is more in security

→ No renegotiation anymore

⇒ Key Upgrade feature, when rekeying *inside* same TLS session is required

→ HKDF officially included

→ A few simplification in EC management

⇒ Single EC point format, no negotiation

→ Removal of compression

⇒ What else? Remember CRIME ☺

→ Exported key [integrates RFC 5705]

⇒ Permits to export to applications a further shared secret key

→ Exporter master secret

→ Prevents application developers to “invent” their own approach!!

⇒ different and independent from the session master key!